

Megan Davidson, M.Res., B.A. (Hons), R.S.E.

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Master CV — compiled August 2026. A complete record of education, experience, funding, publications and presentations to draw on for tailored applications.

PERSONAL PROFILE

PhD researcher in Criminology at the University of Manchester, studying the spatial and architectural dimensions of incarceration, with a current focus on the prison environment's effects on women's self-harm. Background spans community-based and situational-crime-prevention research, social impact technology, and data management, underpinned by a strong record of peer-reviewed and professional publications on rehabilitative architecture, situational crime prevention, and Indigenous experiences within the Canadian correctional system. Also a Red Seal-certified baker.

EDUCATION

University of Manchester — PhD in Criminology

2025 – Present

Thesis: "The Effects of the Prison Environment on Women's Self-Harm: A Mixed-Method Approach to Women's Spatial Experiences." Supervised by Dr Emily Turner, Dr Thiago Oliveira, and Dr Marion Vannier. Funded through the President's Doctoral Scholar Award.

Relevant Activities:

- Founder & Lead, International Early Career and PhD Prison Research Network (2026 – Present)
- [Member, Carceral Geography Working Group, Royal Geographical Society \(with the Institute of British Geographers\)](#) (2026 – Present)
- Graduate Student Reviewer, Canadian Journal of Undergraduate Research (2024 – Present)
- Volunteer, Historical Plant Records Databasing, Firs Botanical Grounds (2026 – Present)
- Befriender, New Bridge (2026 – Present)

University of Liverpool — MRes Criminological Research

2023 – 2024

Pass with Distinction

Dissertation: "Rehabilitative Architecture: A Systematic Literature Review from the UK and Beyond." Supervised by Dr Barry Godfrey. (MRes dissertations are not held in the University of Liverpool's open repository, so no public link is available.)

Relevant Modules:

The Politics and Practices of Social Research; Understanding Society Using Quantitative Methods; Philosophy of Social Science; Introduction to Critical Discourse Analysis*; Participatory Action Research*; Focus Groups*; Researching Sensitive Subjects*; Introduction to Data Visualization Using R; Doing Ethical Research*; Architecture and Power: Parliaments, Prisons and Courts*; Using Foucault's Methods; Visual Data and Visual Analysis*; Ethnomethodology and Conversation Analysis* (*courses audited)

Relevant Activities:

- PGT Student Representative, School of Law and Social Justice (Fall 2023 – Fall 2024)
- PGT Representative, International Criminological Research Unit (ICRU) (Winter 2024 – Summer 2024)
- Curriculum Mapping Volunteer (Fall 2023 – Summer 2024)
- Vegan Community Organiser, The Vegan Society

Training Attended:

- 2023 Research Methods e-Festival (Fall 2023)
- BSA Postgraduate Regional Event: Feminist Enquiry (Fall 2023)
- Off-Campus Risk Assessment Training (Fall 2023)
- Safety for Research Students (Fall 2023)
- Neurodiversity Celebration Symposium (Winter 2024)
- Methods Faire 2024 (Winter 2024)
- Women's Deaths in Prisons: Struggles for Truth, Social Justice and Accountability (Summer 2024)
- The Social Life of Creative Methods (Summer 2024)
- Using Imposter Methods (Summer 2024)
- 15th Irish North/South Criminology Conference (Summer 2024)
- Adopting a Trauma-Informed Approach to Research: Lessons from Practice and Lived Experience (Summer 2024)

Mount Royal University — BA (Hons) Criminal Justice, minor in Psychology

Jan 2019 – May 2023

Grade: 3.98/4.0. Dean's and President's Lists (Fall 2019 – Winter 2023)

Relevant Modules:

Introduction to Research Methods; Quantitative Research Methods & Data Analysis; Qualitative Research Methods; Writing for Academic Success; Research Project 1; Professional Ethics in Criminal Justice

Relevant Activities:

- Honours Thesis: "Addressing Violence in Prisons: An Analysis of Situational Crime Prevention and its Theoretical Application to the Canadian Correctional System." Supervised by Prof. Doug King. [Open Access Repository 7](#)
- Fellow, [Catamount Fellowship](#) (Fall 2022 – Winter 2023) — partnered with United Way of Calgary and Area and Jocelyn Rempel, Faculty of Nursing, exploring "How might we create space for grassroots, community-led approaches in Calgary's larger systems of care?"
- Mentee, Harry G. Schaefer Mentorship Program (Fall 2021 – Winter 2023)
- Volunteer, Mount Royal University Model United Nations (Winter 2020)
- Study Buddy, International Student Support Centre, MRU (Fall 2019 – Winter 2020)
- Pinnacle Leadership Challenge, Students' Association of MRU (Fall 2019 – Winter 2020)

Mount Royal University — Extension Certificate, Administrative Assistant **2018 – 2019**

Relevant Modules: Level 2 MS Excel; Level 2 MS Word; Level 1 MS PowerPoint; Level 2 MS Business Project

Southern Alberta Institute of Technology — Diploma with Honours, Baking & Pastry Arts **2014 – 2016**

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Prison Course — Department of Criminology, University of Manchester **2026 – Present**

- Department of Criminology TA Rep for the 2026–27 academic year.

Data Management Specialist — Andersen Canada **2024 – 2025**

- Daily data entry to databases with a high degree of accuracy.
- Attention to detail across large-scale executive-level client and in-house CRM databases.
- Provided executive project support, administrative help, and data tracking.

Data Management Specialist — CBI Business Solutions (formerly Catherine Brownlee Inc.) **2019 – Present**

- Daily data entry to databases of executive-level clients with a high degree of accuracy.
- Attention to detail across large-scale executive-level client and in-house CRM databases.
- Provided executive project support, administrative help, and data tracking. Proficient in Maximize and Salesforce.

Interim Executive Director and Executive Advisor — Centre for Social Impact Technology **2023 – 2024**

- Worked with social and technology stakeholders, including five volunteers and two staff members, to produce content and facilitate knowledge growth through events.
- Led a 12-member advisory board to establish goals, strategies, and standards for the emerging social impact technology ecosystem.
- Coordinated efforts to identify, initiate contact with, and cultivate new institutional and corporate donor relationships.

Community Outreach Specialist — Centre for Social Impact Technology **2022 – 2023**

- Researched and wrote content for policy briefs, blogs, and knowledge mobilisation efforts.
- Worked with social and technology stakeholders to produce content and facilitate knowledge growth.
- Drafted, developed, and edited materials for publication and presentation.

Research Assistant — Mount Royal University **2022 – 2023**

- Data collection, management, entry, and analysis.
- Planned and modified research techniques, procedures, tests, equipment, and software.
- Drafted, developed, and edited materials for publication and presentation.

Social Innovation Projects Assistant — [Institute for Community Prosperity](#) **2022 – 2023**

- Researched and wrote content for environmental scans, systems-mapping papers, blogs, and knowledge mobilisation efforts.
- Worked with social innovation stakeholders to produce content and facilitate knowledge growth.
- Provided administrative assistance and project management.

President & Past President — Golden Key Honour Society, MRU Chapter **2020 – 2023**

- Organized, planned, and implemented initiatives to support the overall success of the chapter.
- Developed a strategic marketing plan for the membership drive and yearly chapter events.

- Maintained consistent communication with the International Headquarters Associate Director.

Continued as Post-Graduate Alumni Advisor to the chapter, 2023 – Present.

Peer Learning Mentor, Peer Learning Program — Mount Royal University

2019 – 2023

- Supported 13 fellow students in mastering course-specific content by leading a weekly review of class material.
- Engaged participants through active learning strategies and shared effective study skills, contributing 134.25 volunteer hours.

ACHIEVEMENTS & AFFILIATIONS

- Best Dissertation (MRes), School of Law and Social Justice, University of Liverpool (2024)
- Shortlisted Nomination, Course Rep of the Year, Humanities and Social Sciences, University of Liverpool (2024)
- Top 30 Under 30 Award (2023)
- [Fellow, Royal Society for Arts, Manufactures and Commerce \(F.R.S.A.\)](#) (2022 – 2025)
- [Catamount Fellowship](#) (2022/2023)
- Member, Tech & Democracy Working Group, All Tech Is Human (Fall 2022 – Winter 2023)
- International Golden Key Chapter Award (Summer 2022)
- MRU Student Leader Badge: Foundational & Intermediate (Winter 2021)
- Golden Key Honour Society, Mount Royal University Chapter — Member (Fall 2020 – Present); President (2020 – 2023); Post-Graduate Alumni Advisor (2023 – Present)
- Phi Theta Kappa Honour Society (2015 – Present)
- Volunteer Calgary Youth Leaders Award, for volunteer work with the Mustard Seed and other Calgary homelessness agencies (2009)

FUNDING

- President's Doctoral Scholar Award, University of Manchester (2025 – Present) — full funding, £21,780/year
- School of Social Science Studentship, University of Manchester (2025 – Present) — no funding due to President's Award
- 2025–2026 Persons Case Scholarship (Winter 2026) — \$2,500
- University of Manchester Conference Fund — Prison Design and Technology Conference 2026, Rabat, Morocco (2026) — £750
- Carceral Geography Working Group (CGWG) Conference Bursary — 6th International Conference for Carceral Geography, Trier, Germany (2026) — €350
- Department of Criminology Conference Scholarship — 2026 PhD Criminology Conference (2026) — £95
- NABS+ Award — ECR Workshops, Cardiff (2026)
- University of Liverpool Commonwealth Postgraduate Bursary (Fall 2023) — £2,500
- Vice-Chancellor's International Attainment Scholarship (Fall 2023) — £2,500
- 2023 Centennial Gold Medal, Faculty of Arts, MRU (2023) — no funding
- Excellence Award – Bronze, Students' Association of MRU (Winter 2023) — \$2,000
- Laurence Decore Award for Student Leadership (Winter 2023) — \$1,000
- Catamount Fellowship (2022/2023) — \$2,000
- Jason Lang Scholarship (2022/2023) — \$1,000
- Faculty of Arts Achievement Award (Fall 2022) — \$2,200
- Learning Peer Award (Fall 2022) — \$150
- Learning Peer Award (Winter 2022) — \$125
- Learning Peer Award (Winter 2022) — \$250
- 2021–2022 Persons Case Scholarship (Winter 2022) — \$2,500
- Alberta Criminal Justice Association and Canadian Criminal Justice Association Scholarship (Winter 2021) — \$900
- Jason Lang Scholarship (2021/2022) — \$1,000
- Learning Peer Award (Fall 2021) — \$200
- Learning Peer Award (Winter 2021) — \$200
- Learning Peer Award (Fall 2020) — \$200
- Learning Peer Award (Winter 2020) — \$250
- Rising Star Award (Winter 2020) — \$250
- Louise McKinney Post-Secondary Scholarship (Fall 2020) — \$2,500
- Faculty of Arts Achievement Award (Fall 2020) — \$2,200

- International Mobility Award (Fall 2019) — \$1,350
- Learning Peer Award (Fall 2019) — \$200
- Alexander Rutherford Scholarship (2018/2019) — \$1,300

PUBLICATIONS

- Davidson, M. (2026). Rehabilitative architecture: A bar-less future or invisible barrier cemented? [The Canadian Criminal Justice Association Justice Report](#), 40(4).
- Davidson, M. (2024). Inside the walls: Situational crime prevention and its theoretical application to the Canadian correctional system. [The Canadian Criminal Justice Association Justice Report](#), 39(4).
- Davidson, M. (2024). The psychopharmacological haze: Vilification or decriminalization. [The Canadian Criminal Justice Association Justice Report](#), 39(2).
- Davidson, M. (2024). A summary of “Addressing violence in prisons: An analysis of situational crime prevention and its theoretical application to the Canadian correctional system.” [The Canadian Criminal Justice Association Justice Report](#), 38(4).
- Davidson, M. (2023). Psychological explanations: The Terri-Lynne McClintic case. [CJUR](#), 7(3), 6–10.
- Davidson, M. (2023). Waco, Jonestown, Instagram: Deprogramming the world’s largest cults. [The Canadian Criminal Justice Association Justice Report](#), 38(1).
- Davidson, M. (2023). Addressing violence in prisons: An analysis of situational crime prevention and its theoretical application to the Canadian correctional system [Undergraduate Honours Thesis, Mount Royal University]. [Open Access Repository](#).
- Davidson, M. (2022). The Social Impact Technology Summit hosted by the Centre for Social Impact Technology. [The Canadian Criminal Justice Association Justice Report](#), 37(4).
- Davidson, M. (2021). The underlying prejudice in Canadian kindness: A critical examination of the treatment of Indigenous offenders in Canadian correctional programming. [The Canadian Criminal Justice Association Justice Report](#), 36(4).

PRESENTATIONS

- Davidson, M. (2026, September). *Green space in women’s prisons: spatial inequalities, wellbeing, and self-harm* [Conference presentation]. [6th International Conference for Carceral Geography: Carcerality, Borders and Mobility](#) (Universität Trier, Trier, Germany).
- Davidson, M. (2026, August 19). Invited speaker, [ICPA Planning and Design Network Webinar: Creating Better Environments Through Small, Purposeful Design Changes](#) [Webinar]. International Corrections and Prisons Association (online).
- Davidson, M. (2026). *Green Behind Bars: Natural Environments and Mental Health in Women’s Prisons* [Poster presentation]. [Connecting Paths — The 15th National Conference on Critical Perspectives in Criminology and Social Justice](#) (St. Catharines, Ontario, Canada).
- Davidson, M. (2026). *Access Denied: Freedom of Information Requests and the Architecture of Carceral Authority* [Conference presentation]. [University of Cambridge Criminology PGR Conference 2026](#) (Cambridge, UK).
- Davidson, M. (2026). *Power, Access, and Freedom: How Freedom of Information Requests Reflect Carceral Authority* [Conference presentation]. University of Manchester Criminology and Law Symposium 2026 (Manchester, UK).
- Davidson, M. (2026). *A Breath of Fresh Air: Reimagining Women’s Prisons Through Natural Environments and Mental Health* [Conference presentation]. [Prison Design and Technology Conference 2026](#) (Rabat, Morocco).
- Davidson, M. & Davidson, B. (2023). *Building Past the Theoretical: Creating the Bridge Between the Old and the New CPTED* [Conference presentation]. [2023 International ICA Conference: Safe Cities by People](#) (São Paulo, Brazil).
- Davidson, M. (2023, August 31). *ENTR3360 “How Technology Enables Innovation”* [Guest presentation for the Centre for Social Impact Technology].
- Davidson, M. (2023, April 4). *Addressing Violence in Prisons: An Analysis of Situational Crime Prevention and its Theoretical Application to the Canadian Correctional System* [Poster presentation]. [Mount Royal University Research and Scholarship Days](#), Calgary, Alberta, Canada.
- Davidson, M. (2023, April 4). *On the Wings of Change* [Poster presentation]. [Mount Royal University Research and Scholarship Days](#), Calgary, Alberta, Canada.

CONFERENCE ORGANISATION

- Co-Organiser, “*Repoliticising Inequality: Organised Abandonment, Carceral Violence and Actively Working Towards Abolition*” (3-part session series). [Royal Geographical Society \(with IBG\) Annual International Conference 2026](#), Imperial College London (2 September 2026).
- Part 1: Mind — knowing domination (Session PolGRG22, 11:10–12:50)
- Part 2: Body — struggles and resistance (Session PolGRG23, 14:25–16:05)
- Part 3: Heart — hope, imagination, futures (Session PolGRG24, 16:35–18:15)

ADDITIONAL COURSES & CERTIFICATIONS

- Methods and Statistics in Social Sciences Specialization (in progress)
- Maintaining Momentum: Project, Time and Self-Management (July 2026)
- CVs for Researchers: Masterclass (July 2026)
- Results CIC – Achieving Your Potential: Career Development Programme, incl. 1:1 coaching sessions (January–July 2026)
- Writing from a place of calm: using self-shiatsu and qi gong to support your writing journey (July 2026)
- Emotionally Challenging Research: Possible Impacts and Proactive Interventions to Support Researchers (June 2026)
- Using Satellite Imagery and Location-Based Data in Research Pipelines in R (June 2026)
- Methods, Ethics and Positionality in Abolition Feminism Research (June 2026)
- Preparing for the Annual Review for Humanities PGRs (May 2026)
- Intro to French, LEAP, University of Manchester (February–April 2026)
- Discourse Analysis: Terminology and Methods (March 2026)
- Research Impact: Communicating Your Research with a Variety of Groups and Audiences (March 2026)
- Discourse Analysis and Language (March 2026)
- Getting Started with Public Engagement (February 2026)
- Academic Writing for PGRs in Humanities Part 2: Critical Literacy (February 2026)
- How Research Becomes a Tool for Change: From Theory to Action (February 2026)
- Introduction to Research Impact (January 2026)
- Academic Interviews (January 2026)
- Career Options Beyond Academia – Career Hacks for Researchers (January 2026)
- Overcoming Imposter Feelings and Building Self Confidence (January 2026)
- Research Independence - Fellowship grant applications (December 2025)
- Lego Serious Play Workshop, Department of Criminology, U of M (December 2025)
- Managing and sharing research data from human participants (on campus), University of Manchester Library (December 2025)
- PGR Wellbeing Support Workshop (December 2025)
- Introduction to anonymisation techniques for social sciences research data, UK Data Service (November 2025)
- Resilience for PGRs: Managing the challenges of research, University of Manchester Library (November 2025)
- Effective Research Presentation (November 2025)
- Trauma Informed Qualitative Research, Qualitative Training (November 2025)
- Best practices for documenting social sciences research data, UK Data Service (November 2025)
- Code Anxiety Club: Project Organisation: Best Practices for Coding Projects, UK Data Service (November 2025)
- PGR Wellbeing Support Workshop (November 2025)
- Building Futures - Prison Reform Trust Conference 2025, PRT (November 2025)
- Role of informed consent in ethical data collection, sharing and reuse, UK Data Service (November 2025)
- Sharing research with confidence developing your public speaking skills (on campus), University of Manchester Library (October 2025)
- Managing Long Documents in Word, University of Keele (October 2025)
- Mixed Methods Under Review: Lessons from a PhD Defense, MMIRA (October 2025)
- Introduction to Academic Writing Part 1 (October 2025)
- Ethical and legal guidelines in data sharing, UK Data Service (October 2025)
- Reflective Practices for Researchers, Keele University (October 2025)
- My Research Essentials: Starting Your Research Journey, University of Manchester Library (October 2025)
- My Research Essentials: Creating and Managing Your ORCID, University of Manchester Library (October 2025)
- Introduction to effective and practical research data management, UK Data service (October 2025)
- Starting Postgraduate Research in Humanities (October 2025)
- Dangerous Writing: A Symposium on the Ethics, and Practicalities of Working with Risky Texts, University of Manchester (September 2025)

- Induction to Postgraduate Research in the Faculty of Humanities, PGR Research Development (September 2025)
- TSLD166 Diversity in the Workplace for Postgraduate Researchers, ED&I Team (September 2025)
- Mindfulness for Postgraduate Researchers, University of Manchester Library (July 2025)
- Data Protection and Cyber Security (PGRs) (January 2025)
- Project Management Simplified (September 2024)
- Design Thinking, Social Innovation, and Complex Systems (September 2024)
- Thinking Creatively (September 2024)
- Mistakes to Avoid When Managing Your Time (September 2024)
- Python vs. R for Data Science (September 2024)
- PGR Student Health and Safety Induction Module 5 - Off-campus work (including fieldwork) (August 2024)
- PGR Student Health and Safety Induction Mandatory Module 1 (August 2024)
- Enhance Your Productivity with Effective Notetaking (July 2024)
- Administrative Professional Foundations (June 2024)
- Career Essentials in Administrative Assistance by Microsoft and LinkedIn (June 2024)
- Collaborating with Microsoft 365 (June 2024)
- Communication Foundations (June 2024)
- Data Storytelling Basics (June 2024)
- Getting Started with Microsoft 365 (June 2024)
- Managing a Diverse Team (June 2024)
- Note Taking for Business Professionals (June 2024)
- Optimizing Your Work with Microsoft 365 (June 2024)
- Time Management Fundamentals (June 2024)
- Learning Design Research (May 2024)
- Skills that Set Data Scientists Apart (May 2024)
- Speaking Confidently and Effectively (April 2024)
- Writing a Proposal (January 2024)
- Academic Research Foundations: Quantitative (January 2024)
- Statistics Foundations 1: The Basics (January 2024)
- Data Visualization: Storytelling (January 2024)
- Research Ethics in Practice (October 2023)
- Working Ethically in Global Environments (October 2023)
- Working Ethically in Challenging Circumstances (October 2023)
- Understanding Research Ethics Approval (October 2023)
- Working with Human Participants (October 2023)
- The Fundamentals of OCAP (January 2023)
- TCPS 2: CORE-2022 (September 2022)
- Core Competency Module for Sex and Gender in the Analysis of Secondary Data from Human Participants (August 2022)
- Core Competency Module for Sex and Gender in Biomedical Research (August 2022)
- Institute of Gender and Health Core Competency Module for Sex and Gender in Primary Data Collection with Human Participants (August 2022)
- Tech Stewardship Practice Program (July 2022)
- Global Health Research Training Module (July 2022)
- Foundations of Humane Tech (May 2022)
- Fundamental Neuroscience for Neuroimaging, Coursera (January 2022)
- The Addicted Brain Certificate, Emory University & Coursera (May 2021)
- Mobilizing Communities to Disrupt Sexual Exploitation and Sex Trafficking in Canada (February 2021)
- RCMP Counter Terrorism Information Officer Workshop (October 2019)
- RCMP Crime Prevention Through Environmental Design Training (May 2019)
- Red Seal Baker Designation (R.S.E.) (2019)
- Certified Journeyman Baker (2019)